



ELEMENTARY SCHOOL TEACHER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Teaching at the elementary level is ideal for those who enjoy working with young children and are interested in education. Elementary school teachers need creativity and enthusiasm to design lessons to help children learn new skills and develop their interests. It is rewarding to help shape a child's emotional, educational, and social growth.



SALARY

Newly qualified teacher ★★★★★

Elementary school principal ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Elementary schools may be public or privately run • Many jobs available worldwide • Pay levels generally low to begin with but increase with experience

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Working with children • English • Mathematics • Science • Arts and crafts • Computers • Problem-solving



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Employers look for a degree in early childhood or elementary education. In most states, teachers must pass the PRAXIS I exam.



LIFESTYLE Though they have summers off, hours are long. Teachers use time outside the classroom to plan lessons, talk to parents, and do further training.



LOCATION While most work is classroom based, there are also teaching opportunities in hospitals and schools run by the armed forces.



THE REALITIES Class sizes can be very large. Teachers can expect to have to instruct children of varying skill levels and backgrounds.

CAREER PATHS

Once qualified, and with several years of experience, elementary school teachers can choose to coordinate school-wide efforts in key areas, such as numeracy, literacy, or special needs, or take up senior positions, such as a assistant principal or principal.

STUDENT TEACHER While studying for your degree, you can support qualified educators as a student teacher. This is an excellent way for young teachers to learn how to run a classroom.

GRADUATE To become an elementary school teacher, you must be proficient in English, mathematics, and science. Most teachers hold a bachelor's degree, and some hold graduate-level teaching qualifications. There may be opportunities to study and train on the job.

